

UNIT 9: INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

A. FOREIGN RELATIONS BETWEEN THE VIETNAM COAST GUARD AND OTHER COAST GUARDS IN THE WORLD

I. INTRODUCTION

International relations are an important task of the Vietnam Coast Guard, contributing to the victory of the mission of protecting our country's sovereignty, sovereign rights and jurisdiction at sea, thereby enhancing the role, position and responsibility of Vietnam as a coastal country to countries in the region and the world. This lesson will introduce the achievements of the Vietnam Coast Guard's foreign affairs in recent years and the direction of implementing external missions in the following years.



The Japan Coast Guard ship visits and exchanges with the Vietnam Coast Guard.

II. TEXT

The Vietnam Coast guard (VCG) is the young branch of the Vietnamese People's Army (VPA) and plays an important role in maintaining security and stability in the country's exclusive economic zone and continental shelf. The VCG

also contributes to the protection of Vietnam's sovereignty and national interests in the East Sea.

To handle with these challenges and enhance its capacity and **professionalism**, the VCG has actively expanded its foreign relations and international cooperation with other coast guards and maritime law enforcement agencies in the world. The VCG has participated in various **bilateral** and **multilateral** mechanisms, such as the Heads of Asian Coast Guard Agencies Meeting (HACGAM), the ASEAN Coast Guard Forum (ACGF), the Regional Cooperation Agreement on Combating Piracy and Armed Robbery against Ships in Asia (ReCAAP), and the International Maritime Organization (IMO).

The VCG has also established direct ties with many coast guards in the region and beyond, such as Japan, China, India, Australia, South Korea, Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand, Cambodia, Laos, Singapore, Brunei, Myanmar, the Philippines, France, Italy, Russia, Canada, and the United States. The VCG has conducted regular exchanges of visits, dialogues, consultations, **joint patrols**, exercises, training courses, workshops, seminars, and information sharing with these partners. These activities have helped to build trust, mutual understanding, and coordination



among the coast guards in addressing common maritime security issues such as piracy, smuggling, illegal fishing, marine pollution, search and rescue, and humanitarian assistance.

The JCG delegation visits Ship 8002 of the Vietnam Coast Guard Region 2 Command. Photo: People's Army Newspaper



*The ICG young officers listening to briefing of 2500-nautical mile voyage of the Vietnam Coast Guard ship form Vung Tau to Chennai port.
Photo: People's Army Newspaper.*



The U.S. Coast Guard Rear Adm. Michael J. Haycock during the handover ceremony of a former Coast Guard Cutter to the Vietnam Coast Guard.

One of the most notable examples of VCG's foreign relations and international cooperation is its partnership with the US coast guard (USCG), which has been strengthened in recent years as part of the US-Vietnam comprehensive partnership. The USCG has provided various forms of support to the VCG, such as transferring two former USCG cutters to the VCG under the Excess Defense Articles program, providing training and equipment for maritime law enforcement, conducting joint patrols and professional exchanges, and facilitating VCG's participation in regional forums such as HACGAM and ACGF. The US- Vietnam Coast guard cooperation has contributed to enhancing Vietnam's maritime domain awareness and sovereignty protection as well as promoting regional stability and security.

The VCG's foreign relations and international cooperation have not only improved its own capabilities and performance but also reflected Vietnam's active and responsible role in regional and global affairs. The VCG has demonstrated its commitment to upholding international law and norms, especially the 1982 United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS), and to cooperating with other coast guards for a peaceful and prosperous maritime environment. The VCG's foreign relations and international cooperation are expected to continue and deepen in the future as Vietnam pursues its vision of becoming a strong maritime nation.

B. THE FIRST “VIETNAM COAST GUARD AND FRIENDS” PROGRAM FOR PEACE, FRIENDSHIP, COOPERATION, DEVELOPMENT.

I. TEXT

From 8th to 11th November 2022, the first "Vietnam Coast Guard and Friends" program held in Vietnam with the goal “For secure, safe seas and clean environment”. This will be the first time the VCG High Command has held an exchange program with its counterparts from other countries in the region, especially neighboring countries and those that share maritime borders with Vietnam. Foreign organizations that participated in the program include the National Committee for Maritime Security of Cambodia, the Chinese Coast Guard, the Maritime Security Agency of Indonesia, the Maritime Enforcement Agency of Malaysia, the Philippine Coast Guard, and the Maritime Enforcement Command Center of Thailand.

The program is aimed at realizing and effectively carrying out diplomatic policies of the Party and the state; as well as resolutions, directives, and plans of the Central Military Commission and the Ministry of National Defense on international integration and defense diplomacy this year and in the coming years. In addition, the program helped enhance mutual understanding, trust, and consensus among maritime law enforcement agencies of countries in their cooperation, thus joining hands to build a peaceful, prosperous, and developed marine area.

The VCG has gradually built trusted and stable cooperative relationships with the coast guard forces of many other ASEAN countries. The VCG has also been a contributing member with a high sense of responsibility in multilateral forums in the region and the world as a whole.

The "Vietnam Coast Guard and Friends" program held in Ha Noi

The VCG has established partnerships with **counterparts** in the U.S, China, Japan, South Korea, and India.

To date, the VCG has implemented cooperative documents inked with maritime law enforcement agencies of eight countries, including China, the U.S., Japan, South Korea, India, Cambodia, the Philippines, and Indonesia.

III. GRAMMAR

A. PASSIVE VOICE

1. Present Simple

S + am/is/are + P_{II}

E.g. English is spoken all over the world.

Toyota cars are made in Japan.

2. Past Simple

S + was/were + P_{II}

E.g. My motorbike was stolen last week.

These buildings were built by Chinese workers.

How was the window broken?

3. Simple Future

S+ will be + P_{II}

E.g. 10,000 cars will be produced next years.

Will the computer be repaired next week?

4. Present Continuous

S + am/is/are+ being + P_{II}

E.g. The football match is being played by Manchester United and Chelsea.
The bags are being made by hands.`

5. Present Perfect

S + have/has + been + P_{II}

E.g. Many hand-made products have been developed by the people in here.
How many letters have been written to her since then?

6. Modal Verbs

S + can/ could/ should + be + P_{II}

E.g. A lot of Coca-Cola can be drunk by teenagers.

***Note:**

1. Active: Shakespeare wrote Hamlet.

Obj.

Passive: Hamlet was written by Shakespeare.

S

2. "Give, send, show..." have 2 objects (a person and a thing)

She gave me a book on my birthday.

➡ I was given a book on my birthday.

➡ A book was given to me on my birthday.

B. The Past Simple tense

1. Use

The Past Simple tense is used to express:

- Completed action in the past.
- Series of actions in the past.
- A habit in the past.

E.g: I studied at Ha Noi last year.

He stayed home yesterday.

2. Form

a) Positive

S+V_{-ed}

E.g. He escaped from the prison last week.

b) Negative

S+ did + not + V_{inf}

E.g. She didn't say goodbye to me when she passed me yesterday

c) Questions

- Yes/No question

Did + S + V_{inf}?

- Yes, S + did.

- No, S + did + not.

E.g. Did you meet your friends at the party?

Yes, I did.

- Wh-question:

Wh+ did+S+ V_{inf}?

E.g. Why did you choose this university?

- Because I wanted to be an officer.

3. Notes

a) The rules of the Simple Past tense forms

- If the verb ends in "e", add "d".

E.g. live – lived love - loved

- If the verb ends in a consonant + "y", change "y" to "ied".

E.g. marry – married study- studied

- Regular verbs ending in a vowel + "y", take "ed" in the simple past and past participle.

E.g. play- played

- If the one-syllabled verbs end in one vowel + one consonant, double the consonant.

E.g. stop-stopped plan - planned

- All the other regular verbs take "ed" in the simple past and past participle.

E.g. visit - visited work - worked

b) Pronunciation of the ending "ed"

-/t/: worked, finished, stopped, laughed, passed (ending by k, s, p, f, s)

-/d/: lived, died, loved, cleaned, stayed, moved (ending the last sounds)

-/id/: started, needed, visited, invited (ending by /d/; (+/))

c) Time expressions

- Yesterday: yesterday morning, yesterday afternoon, yesterday evening
- Ago: four days ago, two weeks ago, two years ago, three months ago,...
- Last: last night, last week, last month, last year, last Monday,...

B. The Past Continuous tense

1. Use

The Past Continuous tense is used to express:

- An activity happening at the specific time in the past. (Duration)
- The activities happening at the same time in the past.
- An activity happening, and then another activity interrupted it.

E.g. We were watching TV at 8 o'clock last night.

He was playing tennis at that time.

2. Form

a) Positive

S+ was/were+V-ing

E.g. I was learning English at this time yesterday.

b) Negative

S+ was/ were+not+ V-ing

E.g. They weren't listening to their teacher when she was teaching them.

c) Questions

- Yes/No question

Was/Were+S+ V-ing?

Yes, S+ was/ were

No, S+was/ were + not

E.g. Were you watching TV when the telephone rang?

-Yes, I was.

- Wh-question:

Wh+be+S+V-ing?

E.g. What were you doing when I phoned you yesterday?

3. Prepositions in time expressions

NO PREPOSITION	IN	AT	ON
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yesterday	in the morning/ evening	at six o'clock	on Saturday
last night		at midnight	on Monday morning
last week	in December	at Christmas	on Christmas Day
two weeks ago	in summer	at the weekend	
yesterday evening	in 1995		on January 18th
tonight	in two weeks' time		
today			
this evening			

IV. VOCABULARY

1	Professionalism	/prə'feʃnə'lɪzəm/	n	Sự chuyên nghiệp
2	Bilateral	/baɪ'lætərəl/	a	Song phương
3	Multilateral	/ˌmʌltɪ'lætərəl/	a	Đa phương
4	Joint patrols			Tuần tra chung
5	Strengthen	/'streŋθən/	v	Làm sâu sắc thêm
6	Humanitarian assistance		n	Hỗ trợ nhân đạo
7	Comprehensive partnership		n	Đối tác toàn diện
8	Cutter	/'kʌtə/	n	Tàu tuần duyên
9	Maritime law enforcement			Thực thi pháp luật trên biển
10	Conduct	/'kɒndʌkt/	v	Tiến hành
11	International cooperation		n	Hợp tác quốc tế
12	Norm	/nɔ:m/	n	Chuẩn mực
13	Foreign relations		n	Quan hệ đối ngoại
14	Pursue	/pə'sju: /	v	Hướng tới
15	Diplomatic policies			Chính sách ngoại giao
16	Mutual understanding			Thấu hiểu lẫn nhau
17	Consensus	/kən'sen.səs/	n	Sự đồng ý

18	Coordin ation	/kou ,ɔ:r.dən'ei.ʃən/	n	Sự phối hợp
19	Multilateral forums			Diễn đàn đa phương
20	Counterpart	/'kaʊn.tə.pa:rt/	n	Đối tác
21	Implement	/'im.plə.ment/	v	Triển khai

V. PRACTICE

Exercise 1. Chose the correct answer

1. The cake _____ by my mother.

(a) was made

(b) made

(c) is made

2. The letter _____ yesterday.

(a) was sent

(b) sent

(c) is sent

3. The car _____ every week.

(a) is washed

(b) washed

(c) was washed

4. The window _____ by the ball.

(a) was broken

(b) broken

(c) is broken

5. The flowers _____ every day.

(a) are watered

(b) watered

(c) were watered

6. The book _____ by the author.

(a) was written

(b) written

(c) is written

7. The house _____ last year.

(a) was built

(b) built

(c) is built

8. The food _____ by the chef.

(a) was cooked

(b) cooked

(c) is cooked

9. The song _____ by the singer.

(a) was sung

(b) sung

(c) is sung

10. The picture _____ by the artist.

(a) was painted

(b) painted

(c) is painted

Exercise 2: Chose the correct answer

1. The phone _____ by the company.

(a) was produced

(b) produced

(c) is produced

2. The test _____ tomorrow.

(a) will be graded

(b) graded

(c) is graded

3. The package _____ next week.

(a) will be delivered

(b) delivered

(c) is delivered

4. The movie _____ by the director.

(a) was directed

(b) directed

(c) is directed

5. The game _____ by the team.

(a) was won

(b) won

(c) is won

6. The speech _____ by the politician.

(a) was given

(b) given

(c) is given

7. The prize _____ to the winner.

(a) will be awarded

(b) awarded

(c) is awarded

8. The story _____ by the journalist.

(a) was reported

(b) reported

(c) is reported

9. The project _____ next month.

(a) will be completed

(b) completed

(c) is completed

10. The contract _____ by both parties

(a) was signed

(b) signed

(c) is signed

Exercise 3: Fill the blank with appropriate verbs/adjectives

1. The cake _____ by my mother.
2. The letter _____ yesterday.
3. The car _____ every week.
4. The window _____ by the ball.
5. The flowers _____ every day.
6. The book _____ by the author.
7. The house _____ last year.
8. The food _____ by the chef.
9. The song _____ by the singer.
10. The picture _____ by the artist.

Exercise 4: *Fill the gap with the appropriate linking words in the box*

- | | |
|---|---------------|
| 1. At the recent meeting to prepare for the program | |
| 2. also | 3. As planned |
| 4. In addition | 5. especially |

The “Vietnam Coast Guard and Friends” exchange to take place in December



The event is expected to draw the participation of six delegations of law enforcement forces from six countries, which are the National Committee for Maritime Security (NCMS) of Cambodia, the Coast Guard Department of China, the Indonesian Maritime Security Agency (Bakamla), the Malaysian Maritime Enforcement Agency (MMEA), the Coast Guard of the Philippines, and Thailand Maritime Enforcement Coordinating Center (Thai-MECC).

....., the exchange program will include foreign missions' courtesy calls on the Vietnamese Defense Minister, bilateral meetings between the Vietnamese Coast Guard and delegations and between participants, a banquet hosted by the Vietnam Coast Guard Command, an exchange, and a seminar under the theme "Vietnam Coast Guard and friends."

....., participating coast guard forces will attend the Vietnam International Defense Exhibition and tour the capital city of Vietnam.

....., the Vietnam Coast Guard Command asked its affiliated agencies and units to thoroughly grasp the purpose and meaning of the exchange, be fully aware of their assigned missions, heighten their responsibilities and strengthen coordination to make thorough preparations for the event.

The "Vietnam Coast Guard and friends" exchange program is hosted to enhance mutual understanding and trust and create a high consensus in coordination in performing tasks between the Vietnam Coast Guard and maritime law enforcement forces of other countries in the region, neighboring countries and those with adjacent waters, to build security and safety and clean environment at sea.

The event will be a foundation for the Vietnam Coast Guard forces to implement external and international cooperation activities in the coming years.

Exercise 5: Choose the correct form of the verb to complete the sentences

1. She (to be)___ very excited about her trip
2. He (to take)___ a lot of pictures during his vacation
3. They (to make)___ a cake for their mom's birthday
4. I (to give)___ my sister a present

5. We (to receive)___ a letter from our grandparents
6. She (to find)___ her lost wallet
7. He (to lose)___ his phone at the park
- 8.They (to choose)___ pizza for dinner
9. I (to bring)___ some snacks for the road trip
10. We (to catch)___ a fish while fishing

Exercise 6: Choose the correct answer

1. ___ was he tired after ?
 - a. What
 - b. When
 - c. Where
 - d. Who
2. ___ did she drink a cup of coffee this morning ?
 - a. What time
 - b. When
 - c. Where
 - d. Who
3. ___ did they laugh at ?
 - a. What
 - b. When
 - c. Where
 - d. Who
4. ___ did I finish before dinner ?

a. What time

b. When

c. Where

d. Who

5.____did we start early in the morning ?

a. What time

b. When

c. Where

d. Who

6.____did we receive a letter from ?

a. Who

b. When

c. Where

d. What time

7.____was she excited about ?

a. What

b. When

c. Where

d. Who

8.____did he take a lot of pictures during ?

a. What time

b. When

c. Where

d. Who

9.____did they make a cake for ?

a. Whose birthday

b. When

c. Where

d. Who

10. ____ did I give a present to ?

a. Who

b. When

c. Where

d. What time

Exercise 7. Discuss these questions with your partner.

1. What would be the worst thing about being homeless?

Think about:

the weather

other people's attitudes

being alone

being uncomfortable

personal safety

hygiene

2. What should governments do to tackle the problem of homelessness?

3. What can individuals do to help the homeless?

I think the worst thing would be not having a bed/ feeling cold all the time / not being able to wash....